

INVESTOR BUSINESS PLAN | AUGUST 2026

LOCAL MISSIONS

The operating system for paid, measurable local creator activations

Orlando beachhead • U.S. expansion thesis • Confidential working draft



Original concept image generated for Local Missions. The scene is illustrative and uses synthetic people and businesses.

INVESTOR THESIS Fund the proof, not the pitch: Local Missions becomes venture-scale only if it proves dense local liquidity, repeat business demand, and software-like contribution margins.

Prepared from current market research and the Local Missions product plan. Forecasts are illustrative, not audited, and not legal, tax, accounting, or investment advice.

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Business plan at a glance

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READING LENS This is a venture case with explicit conditions. The plan distinguishes external facts from management assumptions, and it treats the Orlando pilot as an experiment designed to invalidate weak economics quickly.

01 Executive verdict

The concept is investable as a disciplined local-commerce marketplace—not as another generic influencer directory.

VERDICT CONVICTION WITH CONDITIONS. Local Missions attacks a real and growing budget category, but the company must prove repeatable local liquidity and keep manual service from turning the platform into a low-margin agency.

Local Missions connects location-based businesses with local adults who complete clearly scoped, paid promotional missions. A mission may require a verified visit, original vertical video and photos, an optional disclosed social post, and a measurable action through a Local Pass, QR code, booking link, or redemption. The product coordinates the brief, participant fit, funding status, on-site verification, deliverables, content rights, review, payout tracking, and results reporting in one workflow.

The strategic wedge is not influencer fame. It is reliable local execution. Businesses often need authentic content and foot traffic but cannot afford an agency, do not know which creators will actually show up, and struggle to connect social activity to store visits or sales. Everyday creators want legitimate paid opportunities without needing a massive audience. Local Missions converts that mismatch into a repeatable marketplace transaction.

Why this can be large

- Budget tailwind: IAB expects U.S. creator ad spend to reach \$44 billion in 2026 after \$37 billion in 2025, while buyers still cite creator selection, measurement, and fragmented operations as major gaps. [1]
- Customer breadth: the United States has 36.2 million small businesses; Florida alone has about 3.49 million. Local Missions needs only the location-based, mission-suitable subset—not the whole number—to build a meaningful market. [2]
- Strong Orlando test bed: Orlando welcomed a record 76.7 million visitors in 2025, and the metro population approached 3.0 million. The market has unusually dense restaurants, attractions, experiences, hospitality, retail, and family-oriented demand. [4][5]
- Marketplace economics: creators can join free, while businesses pay for completed value. That asymmetric pricing is consistent with two-sided-platform theory: subsidize the side whose participation most increases value for the paying side. [7][8]
- Strategic scarcity: enterprise creator platforms optimize reach and content at scale; gig apps optimize labor fulfillment; local ad products optimize impressions. Few products combine verified

in-person participation, licensed UGC, transparent payments, and local attribution for SMB-sized budgets.

The three things that must be true

1. Businesses repeat. A one-off campaign marketplace is a services treadmill. The target is at least 40% business repeat within 90 days during pilot and 60% annual retention before aggressive scaling.
2. Creators complete reliably. The platform must fill at least 80% of eligible slots within 72 hours and sustain at least 90% verified completion with low dispute rates.
3. The work becomes software. Mission-level contribution margin must exceed 55% in pilot and trend toward 65%–75% as review, fraud, support, and media operations become standardized.

Investor question	Required answer before scale
Is demand real?	20+ paying design partners; 200+ funded missions; no reward subsidy masquerading as revenue.
Is liquidity real?	≥80% fill within 72 hours in the target cell; ≥90% verified completion.
Is retention real?	≥40% 90-day business repeat; ≥45% creator second-mission rate.
Are margins real?	≥55% mission contribution margin including support, verification, fraud reserve, and media costs.
Is attribution useful?	≥60% of campaigns capture a verifiable downstream action, not only likes or impressions.

02 The problem and the wedge

Local creator marketing is growing, but the last mile between a campaign brief and a measurable in-person outcome is still fragmented.

Business pain

A local operator can buy boosted posts, hire an agency, search a national creator marketplace, or message individuals directly. None of those choices reliably solves the complete operating problem: Who is actually local? Who will arrive during the required window? What exactly will they deliver? Which content rights were granted? Was the material connection disclosed? When should payment advance? Did anyone redeem an offer or book after the activation?

- Search cost: finding relevant local people is manual, slow, and often driven by vanity metrics.

- Execution risk: no-shows, unclear briefs, inconsistent files, and revision disputes consume owner time.
- Trust risk: creators fear nonpayment; businesses fear paying before work is complete.
- Measurement gap: impressions do not prove a visit, redemption, booking, or purchase.
- Rights and compliance gap: usage terms, sponsorship disclosure, and honest-review rules are frequently handled in scattered messages.

Creator pain

Most people will never be full-time influencers, and that is the point. Local Missions treats reliable local participation, content ability, mission fit, and honest execution as productive capacity. A participant can earn a guaranteed reward and receive an experience without needing a public following. Larger or especially relevant audiences can earn an optional, clearly disclosed distribution bonus; follower count is not the universal gate.

The wedge

WEDGE Start with visually rich, location-based Orlando businesses that already buy content or promotions and can measure a visit: independent attractions, family experiences, restaurants/cafes, fitness/wellness, and selected local retail.

The ideal first customer has an average ticket above roughly \$25, meaningful repeat or referral value, unused capacity during specific windows, and a product that is naturally documented with photos or vertical video. The initial product should not attempt every local business category. Dense vertical focus improves mission comparability, support playbooks, creator fit, and attribution.

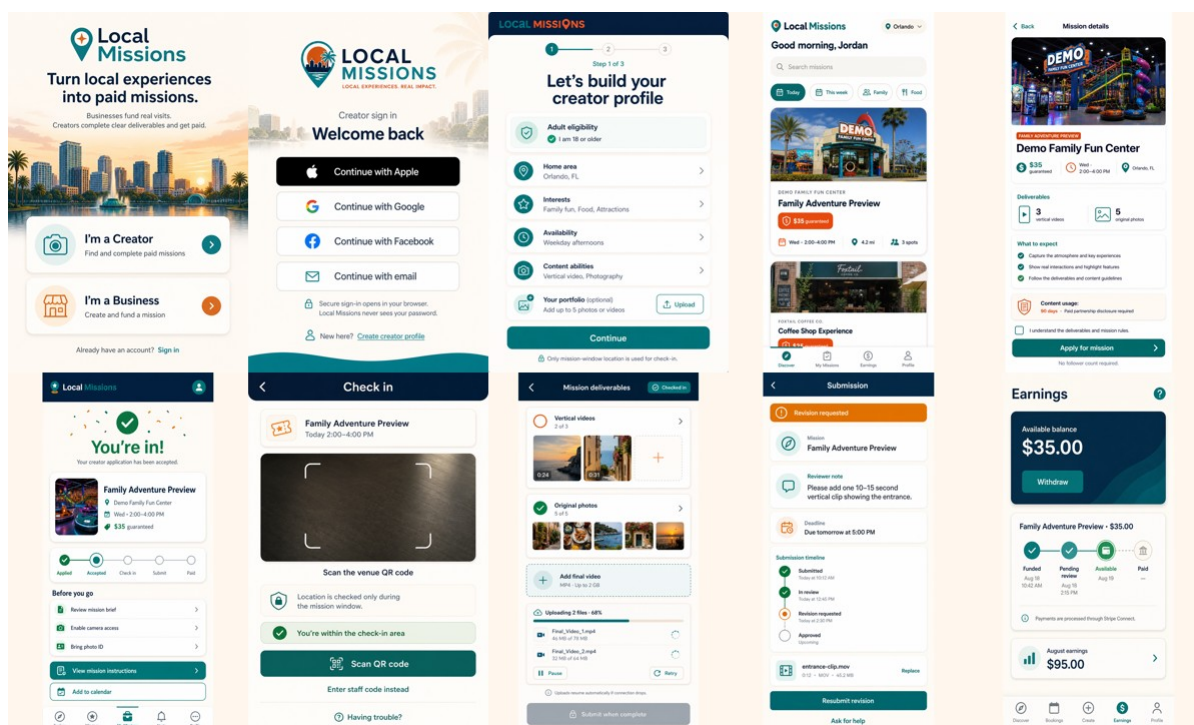
03 Product and value proposition

The product is a trusted workflow from funded brief to verified visit, licensed content, approved reward, and measurable result.

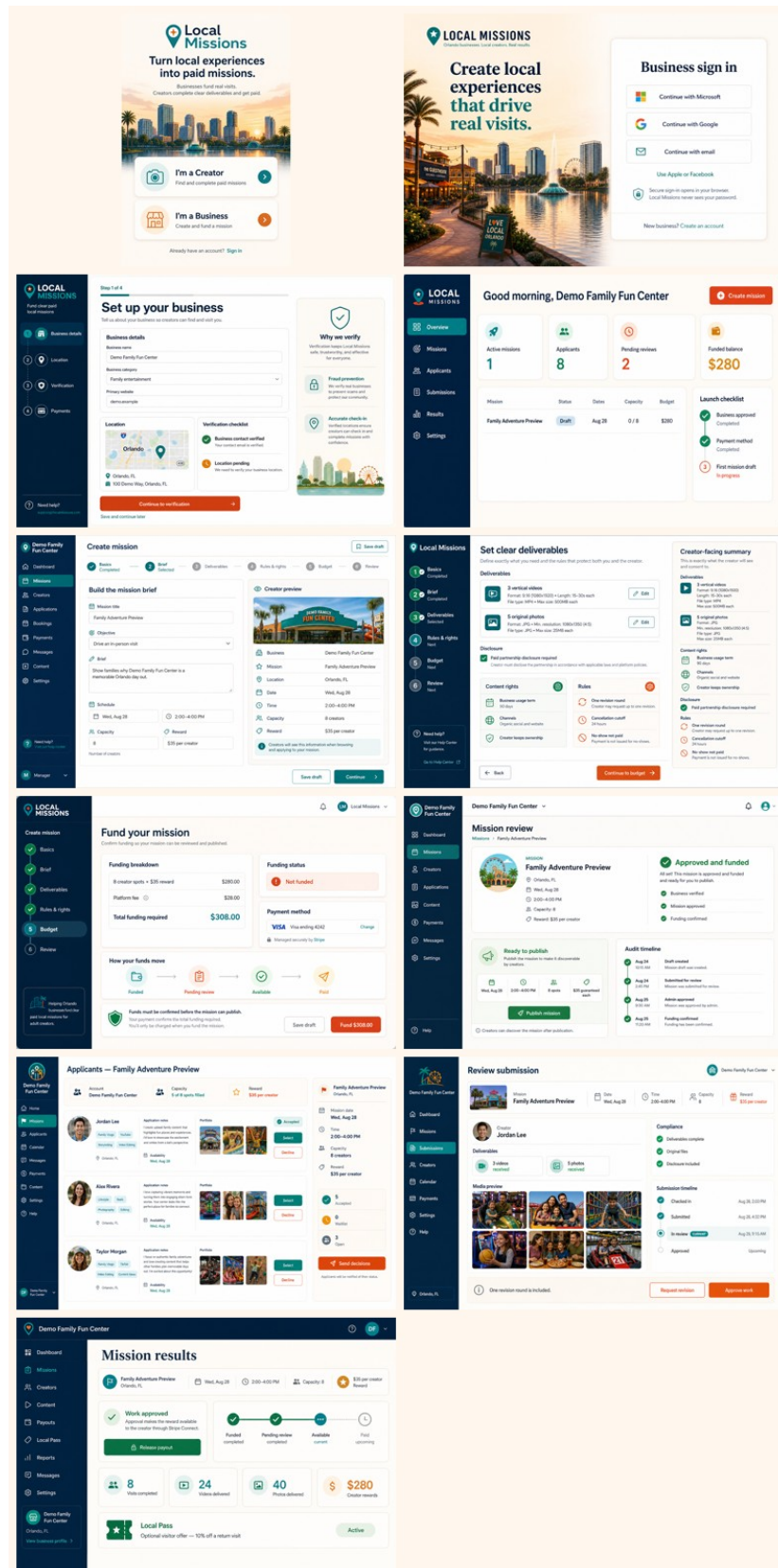
Stage	Creator experience	Business value	Proof created
Fund	Sees guaranteed reward and terms before applying	Confirms budget before publication	Funding confirmation and audit event
Match	Applies based on fit, schedule, distance, and skills	Selects for mission relevance—not popularity alone	Application, portfolio, consent, decision
Visit	Checks in during the mission window	Confirms the right person arrived	Rotating QR/staff code + coarse time/location proof

Stage	Creator experience	Business value	Proof created
Deliver	Uploads the agreed original media	Receives organized, licensed assets	File counts, versions, brief snapshot, rights record
Review	Gets one clear revision path and support	Approves against agreed scope	Decision, reason, revision history
Pay	Tracks Funded → Pending review → Available → Paid	Releases payment only through the defined workflow	Ledger, processor events, payout status
Measure	Optional disclosed posting bonus	Tracks Local Pass, code, booking, redemption, or purchase	Attributed action and campaign report

PAYMENT-LANGUAGE RULE Local Missions provides escrow-like confidence through transparent states and processor-backed workflows, but it must not call the product “escrow” unless licensed counsel and the payment partner approve that exact structure.



Creator journey concept: discover, apply, check in, deliver, revise if needed, and track payout. Concept art—not implementation evidence.



Business journey concept: verify, build, fund, select, review, and measure a mission. Concept art—not implementation evidence.

Product boundaries that protect the thesis

- No public social feed, swiping, creator-to-creator chat, or popularity leaderboard in the MVP.
- No continuous background location tracking; use mission-window-only and privacy-minimized proof.
- No requirement for positive reviews. Required posts must be honest and clearly disclose payment, free meals, products, or experiences.
- No stored-value wallet, cryptocurrency, or off-ledger payout system.
- No second city until the first Orlando cell reaches liquidity, completion, repeat, and contribution-margin gates.

04 Where Local Missions fits in the economy

Local Missions is economic infrastructure at the intersection of four large systems: local commerce, the creator economy, flexible work, and marketplace payments.

Economic layer	What exists today	Local Missions' role
Creator economy	Brand sponsorships, UGC production, affiliate commerce, audience monetization	Opens paid work to everyday local adults and ties content to verified real-world participation.
SMB advertising	Search, social ads, local media, agencies, direct outreach	Packages a measurable local activation at a price and complexity level an independent operator can use.
Experience / visitor economy	Attractions, restaurants, events, wellness, hospitality, retail	Turns perishable local capacity and experiences into content, visits, referrals, and attributable offers.
Flexible work	Gigs, freelance creative services, promotional staffing	Defines a bounded outcome with transparent scope, reward, rights, and payment status rather than hourly open-ended labor.
Fintech / platform ops	Marketplace onboarding, payment processing, payouts, ledgering	Adds trust and auditable state transitions without holding itself out as a bank or licensed escrow provider.

Value creation

For businesses, the platform reduces search, coordination, and measurement costs. For creators, it converts local time, judgment, and content skill into paid opportunities. For consumers, it increases discovery of local experiences through content that originates with actual visits. For the regional

economy, it routes a portion of marketing spend to local individuals and gives smaller venues a performance-oriented alternative to large agencies.

Value capture

The company captures a percentage of mission GMV for coordination, verification, workflow, content-rights records, reporting, and payment operations. Later, it can add subscription revenue for multi-location planning, reusable templates, team permissions, asset libraries, advanced reporting, and agency workspaces. The company should not monetize raw location data or identity documents; privacy erosion would damage both trust and strategic value.

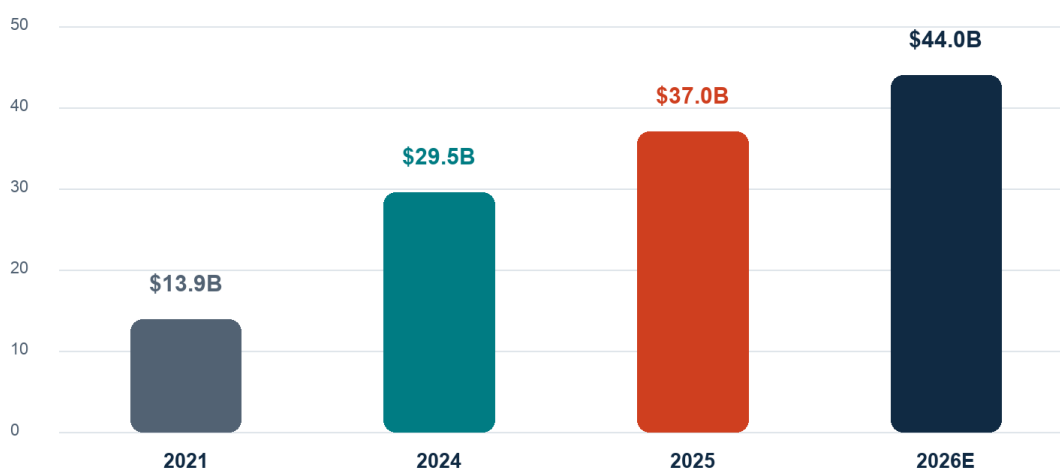
STRATEGIC IDENTITY The winning category is “local activation infrastructure,” not “influencer marketplace.” That framing broadens the buyer, focuses the product on outcomes, and reduces dependence on follower-based social metrics.

05 Market evidence and sizing

External evidence validates the budget and customer base; the actual addressable market is built bottom-up from mission-suitable locations and frequency assumptions.

U.S. creator advertising is becoming a core media channel

IAB reported / projected spend, \$ billions



Source: IAB 2025 Creator Economy Ad Spend & Strategy Report. 2026 is an IAB expectation, not realized spend.

Figure 1. U.S. creator advertising spend. IAB reported \$13.9B in 2021, \$29.5B in 2024, projected \$37B for 2025, and expected \$44B in 2026. [1]

Evidence, with the investor interpretation

- IAB's 2025 study surveyed more than 450 U.S. ad-spend decision-makers and found creators becoming a must-buy channel, while measurement, creator identification, and standardization remained persistent pain points. Local Missions is aimed at those infrastructure gaps, at SMB scale. [1]
- Goldman Sachs Research estimated in 2023 that the global creator economy could grow from about \$250 billion to \$480 billion by 2027. This is a directional forecast—not evidence that Local Missions owns a \$480 billion TAM. [3]
- SBA's 2026 FAQ counts 36.2 million U.S. small businesses. The 2025 profile lists 3.49 million in Florida. The relevant opportunity is the narrower subset with a physical venue, promotable experience, and repeat marketing need. [2]
- Visit Orlando reported 76.7 million visitors in 2025, including 70.3 million domestic and 6.3 million international visitors. City reporting places the 2025 metro population near 2.96 million. The combination creates unusually rich local demand and creator supply. [4][5]
- Academic research finds that informative content, trustworthiness, attractiveness, and perceived similarity support trust in influencer-branded posts, which in turn affects brand awareness and purchase intention. Local Missions operationalizes fit and credibility without assuming that follower count alone produces trust. [6]

Bottom-up market model

Layer	Planning assumption	Mission GMV	Net platform revenue at 18%
Orlando beachhead	2,500 mission-suitable venues × 6 missions/year × \$1,100	\$16.5M	\$3.0M
25-metro SAM	150,000 venues × 6 missions/year × \$1,200	\$1.08B	\$194M
U.S. TAM	1.2M venues × 6 missions/year × \$1,250	\$9.0B	\$1.62B
Year-5 SOM	8,000 active businesses × 12 missions/year × \$1,350	\$129.6M	\$23.3M + \$6.0M SaaS/other

The venue counts above are management assumptions, not published Census totals. Before a priced round, the team should replace them with a reproducible NAICS-by-metro establishment model and a documented eligibility filter. That upgrade matters because investor-quality TAM is a data model, not a large headline number.

Why Orlando is a rational beachhead

- High density of promotable, visual, capacity-sensitive experiences.
- Large resident and visitor pools support both local discovery and travel-related content.
- Geography is bounded enough to manage service quality while still containing multiple neighborhood cells.
- Founder-led partnerships can be concentrated through Main Streets, chambers, tourism networks, agencies, restaurant groups, and local creator communities.
- Seasonality provides a useful stress test for demand forecasting and creator availability.

06 Customer and creator strategy

Build the marketplace around one paying customer profile and one abundant, respected supply profile.

Primary paying customer: the visual local operator

Attribute	Pilot sweet spot
Business type	Independent or small-chain attraction, experience, restaurant/cafe, fitness/wellness, or selected retail.
Marketing team	Owner/operator or 1–5 person marketing team; too small for full-time creator operations.
Economics	AOV roughly \$25+ or meaningful repeat/referral value; can fund \$750–\$2,500 campaigns.
Need	Fresh vertical content, verified visits, event coverage, new offer, seasonal capacity, or Local Pass redemption.
Buying trigger	Opening, launch, menu/service refresh, weekday traffic gap, seasonal event, or paid-media creative fatigue.
Disqualifier	Cannot define deliverables, will not fund rewards, requires positive reviews, or operates in a prohibited/safety-sensitive category.

Primary supply: the reliable local creator

The base mission should be open to adults who meet eligibility and fit requirements, regardless of follower count. Rank for location radius, availability, interests, mission-specific skills, portfolio, reliability, past completion, disclosure behavior, and content quality. A business should see a coarse locality badge—such as “Orlando-area verified” or an approximate service radius—not a home address or exact ZIP code.

Creator layer	Eligibility	Compensation logic
Everyday UGC participant	Adult, local fit, available, able to complete the brief	Guaranteed base reward + included experience; no follower minimum.
Skilled local creator	Stronger portfolio or mission-specific production ability	Higher base reward for scope/quality, not audience size alone.
Distribution add-on	Relevant local audience and verified posting capability	Optional paid bonus for a clearly disclosed post or whitelisted distribution.

MARKETPLACE ETHIC Do not disguise unpaid promotion as opportunity. If a business requires content or posting, the participant receives clear compensation and sees the material terms before applying.

07 Competitive landscape

The competition is not one company. It is a stack of partial substitutes that leave the local execution problem unsolved.

Category / examples	Strength	Structural gap versus Local Missions
Creator marketplaces (Collabstr)	Large searchable supply, payments, campaign tools, analytics	Optimized for creator hiring and social reach; local check-in, venue workflow, and offline attribution are not the core product.
UGC platforms (Insense, Billo)	Fast licensed content production and optional social distribution	Product-shipping/content workflow rather than verified local attendance and repeat venue activation.
Enterprise suites (Sprout/Tagger, Later/Mavely, Influential)	Scale, enterprise data, campaign management, social commerce	Pricing and workflow target larger brands/agencies; local SMB activation is not the primary wedge.
Gig marketplaces (Taskrabbitt and staffing tools)	Local labor fulfillment and trust mechanisms	Do not combine brand-safe creative briefs, content rights, disclosures, attribution, and creator distribution.
Local ad/deal products (Meta, Google, Yelp, Groupon)	Demand generation, discovery, promotions, audience reach	Sell media or deals, not verified visits plus original creator assets and payout workflow.
Agencies / direct DMs	Flexible, relationship-driven, can deliver high-touch strategy	Expensive or operationally fragmented; hard to standardize, audit, and measure at SMB budgets.

Pricing benchmark

Current public pricing shows customers already accept a combination of subscription and transaction fees. Collabstr lists a 10% hiring fee on its free and Pro tiers and 5% on Premium; Pro is \$249/month

billed annually. Insense lists a 20% marketplace fee in trial, 10% in its brand plan, and subscriptions starting around \$500/month. These are not perfect comparables, but they support an 18% pilot take rate for a transaction that adds local verification and operations—provided the workflow truly delivers more value. [12][13]

Positioning map

Dimension	Generic creator marketplace	Local Missions
Unit of value	Creator profile or post	Completed, verified local mission
Primary buyer	Brand/agency	Location-based SMB, multi-location operator, or local agency
Selection	Audience, niche, portfolio, rate	Local fit, availability, reliability, skills, portfolio; audience is optional
Proof	Content delivered / post analytics	Funding, check-in, assets, rights, decisions, payout state, redemption/booking
Moat	Creator directory and workflow	Dense local liquidity + completion data + venue/creator operating history

08 Business model and pricing

Charge the business for completed coordination value; keep creator access free; add subscriptions only after repeat usage is proven.

Revenue stream	Pilot / launch	Later-stage expansion	Investor logic
Mission coordination fee	18% of creator reward GMV	15%–20% by volume/service level	Core transaction revenue; benchmarked within current marketplace ranges.
Payment-cost pass-through	Estimated and reconciled at cost	Negotiated processor economics	Prevents processor expense from hiding weak platform margin.
Business Pro	Not required in pilot	\$99–\$299/month for templates, teams, asset library, analytics, and multi-location tools	Adds recurring revenue only when workflow recurrence exists.
Agency / enterprise workspace	Design-partner pilots	Custom annual contracts + lower transaction rate	Aggregates demand and improves city liquidity.
Distribution / paid	Explicit creator bonus	Workflow and management fee	Separates base UGC

Revenue stream	Pilot / launch	Later-stage expansion	Investor logic
reach add-on			participation from audience amplification.
Attribution / Local Pass	Included baseline reporting	Advanced measurement or performance fee where legally and operationally sound	Links content to local commerce without selling personal data.

Pricing principles

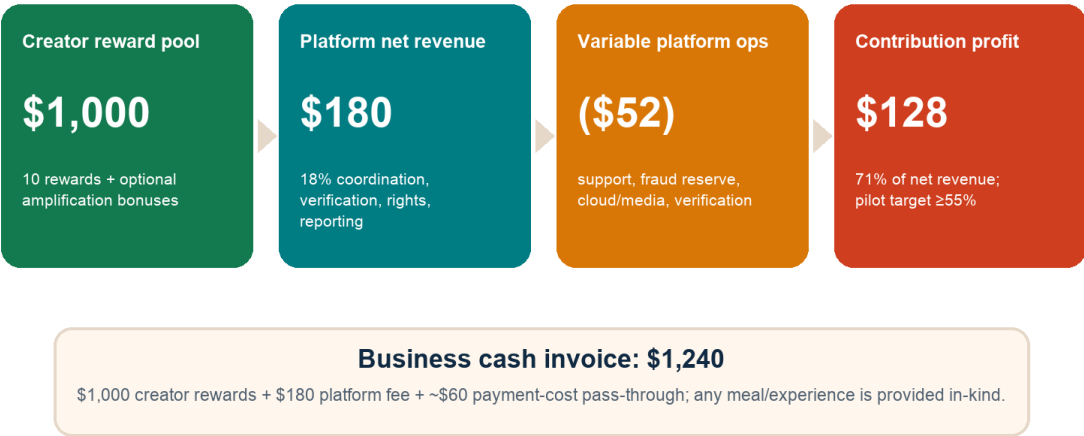
- Show the business the full invoice: creator rewards, platform fee, payment-cost pass-through, taxes, and any optional distribution bonus.
- Show the creator the guaranteed reward and optional bonus separately before application; do not shrink the displayed reward with surprise platform deductions.
- Price content scope and usage rights explicitly. A 30-day organic usage license is not the same product as perpetual paid-media rights.
- Keep the first mission easy to buy, but never subsidize the reward pool to manufacture GMV. Discounts should apply to the platform fee, not creator compensation.
- Move high-frequency operators to subscription + lower take-rate plans only when the economics improve retention and total contribution profit.

09 Unit economics

A venture marketplace is not saved by GMV. It is saved by net revenue, repeat behavior, contribution margin, and declining acquisition/support costs as density improves.

Illustrative \$1,000 mission: value flows to creators first

Base case assumes payment costs are passed through at cost; platform value capture is the coordination fee.



Planning model only. Processor fees, refunds, taxes, support burden, and final pricing must be proven in the pilot.

Figure 2. Illustrative mission unit economics. Payment costs are modeled as a transparent pass-through; creator rewards are GMV, not platform revenue.

Base mission invoice	Amount	Treatment
Creator reward pool	\$1,000	Marketplace GMV / creator payable
Platform coordination fee (18%)	\$180	Net platform revenue
Estimated payment-cost pass-through	\$60	Offset to actual processing/Connect/payout costs
Business cash invoice	\$1,240	Excludes any in-kind meal or experience
Variable platform operations	\$52	Support \$30; verification/fraud reserve \$10; cloud/media/notifications \$12
Contribution profit	\$128	71% of net platform revenue; 10.3% of business cash invoice

Stripe currently lists \$2 per monthly active account plus 0.25% + \$0.25 per payout when the platform handles pricing, with other payment and risk costs depending on the integration. A 10-creator mission can therefore carry meaningful per-account and payout expense before card processing, refunds, disputes, or instant payouts. The pilot must reconcile the pass-through to actual processor statements rather than rely on a blended estimate. [10]

Business acquisition and lifetime value

Metric	Conservative pilot case	Density target case
Business CAC	\$450	\$300
Missions per active business / year	6	8
Average mission GMV	\$1,000	\$1,000
Net platform revenue / mission	\$180	\$180
Contribution margin	60%	68%
Annual business retention	60%	70%
Annual contribution / business	\$648	\$979
Contribution LTV (annual contribution ÷ churn)	\$1,620	\$3,263
LTV / CAC	3.6×	10.9×
CAC payback	4.2 missions / ~8 months	2.5 missions / ~4 months

SCALE GATE Do not buy growth until the trailing cohort shows $\geq 3\times$ contribution LTV/CAC, <12-month payback, and repeat demand that is not founder-dependent.

What moves the economics

- Mission frequency is more valuable than a higher first-order take rate. Six repeat missions produce better LTV than one high-fee campaign.
- Creator retention lowers supply acquisition, onboarding, and failure costs. The second-mission rate is an economic KPI, not a vanity metric.
- Standard briefs and rights templates reduce support minutes and disputes.
- Local density lowers both business CAC and time-to-fill; national breadth without local depth does the opposite.
- Media volume, chargebacks, manual review, and insurance can destroy margin if treated as overhead instead of mission-level variable cost.

10 Network effects and defensibility

The platform can develop real network effects, but they are local, operational, and earned —not automatic.

The defensible asset is local liquidity, not a national creator directory

Cross-side effects compound inside a city cell; quality controls prevent congestion from destroying value.



Expansion rule: do not open the next city until one Orlando cell sustains liquidity, completion, repeat, and contribution-margin gates.

Figure 3. The Local Missions cross-side flywheel. More funded missions improve creator earnings and retention; reliable supply improves fill and fit; better execution increases business repeat.

Rochet and Tirole's foundational model describes platforms that must get both sides on board, and Evans and Schmalensee show why one side may be priced below marginal cost when its participation raises the value of the other side. Local Missions should keep creator access free because creator participation increases selection, speed, and reliability for the business that pays. [7][8]

Four defensibility layers

1. Cross-side local network effects. More quality missions attract reliable local creators; better local supply improves fill and outcomes; better outcomes increase business repeat and referrals.
2. Operational data effects. Completed missions produce reliability, check-in, delivery, revision, rights, dispute, and conversion signals. Those signals improve matching and risk controls without needing invasive personal data.
3. Workflow switching costs. Businesses accumulate reusable briefs, creator histories, approved assets, rights windows, Local Pass performance, and multi-location templates. Creators accumulate trusted completion and payout history.

4. Distribution and partnership advantage. Main Street groups, local agencies, venue networks, and creator communities can become proprietary acquisition channels if performance is better than direct coordination.

Why network effects can fail

Failure mode	Economic mechanism	Countermeasure
Thin local supply	National creator count does not help a mission that needs ten people near one venue Wednesday afternoon	Launch neighborhood/vertical cells; track eligible active supply, not registered accounts.
Creator congestion	Too many creators chasing too few missions reduces earnings and retention	Cap acquisition by cell; waitlists; transparent eligibility; reward reliable repeat participation.
Business multi-homing	Businesses can post to several platforms or DM creators	Win on speed, proof, rights, payout trust, attribution, and saved workflows—not exclusivity tricks.
Off-platform leakage	Repeat pairs may bypass the fee	Make repeat workflow, insurance/support, audit history, payment tracking, and attribution worth more than the take rate.
Manual-service trap	More GMV requires proportional coordinators	Standardize briefs, automation, exception queues, and partner enablement; measure support minutes per mission.

Harvard research on platform interconnectivity distinguishes global marketplaces from local network clusters such as ride-sharing, group buying, local services, and reservations. Local Missions belongs to the local-cluster class: the moat is density within each market, with playbooks and technology creating some intercity leverage. [9]

11 Go-to-market and city expansion

Sequence demand, supply, and geography so the company creates liquidity instead of collecting dormant accounts.

Phase 1: Orlando design-partner cell

1. Recruit 20 anchor businesses in one or two adjacent verticals and two compact geographic cells. Secure signed pilot terms, not letters of vague interest.
2. Recruit 300–500 eligible adult creators from local communities, referrals, colleges, hospitality/creative networks, and existing creator groups—without overloading the cell.
3. Run 50 white-glove missions to discover failure modes and price support. Then run 150 additional missions with progressively standardized workflows.

4. Publish a cohort scorecard: fill time, completion, submission quality, support minutes, disputes, creator repeat, business repeat, attributed actions, and contribution margin.
5. Convert the strongest design partners to standard pricing and referrals. Do not report subsidized pilots as proof of willingness to pay.

Demand channels

Channel	Offer	Reason it can work
Founder-led outbound	Campaign blueprint + transparent \$1,000 example	Fast feedback and control over the first customer profile.
Main Street / chamber / tourism groups	Member workshop + vetted pilot cohort	Aggregated local trust and lower CAC.
Local agencies	White-label/partner workspace and creator operations	Concentrated repeat demand without replacing strategic agency work.
Venue and franchise groups	Multi-location templates and benchmark reporting	Replicable missions and higher frequency.
Creator referrals	Priority or referral bonus after verified completion	High-trust supply growth tied to actual marketplace quality.

City expansion gate

Metric	Minimum for 8 consecutive weeks
Eligible-slot fill within 72 hours	≥80%
Verified completion	≥90%
On-time acceptable submission	≥85%
90-day business repeat	≥40%
Creator second-mission rate	≥45%
Dispute rate	<3%
Mission contribution margin	≥55%
Support time	<30 minutes per completed mission on median

EXPANSION RULE Clone the playbook, not the chaos. The second market opens only after Orlando works without heroic founder intervention.

12 Operating model, technology, and trust

Trust is not a legal page. It is the product architecture, state machine, evidence trail, and exception handling.

Operating model

Capability	MVP approach	Scale approach
Business approval	Manual verification and category review	Risk scoring, document/provider checks, exception queue
Mission approval	Template + admin review	Policy engine, prohibited-term detection, vertical templates
Matching	Eligibility filters + business selection	Reliability/fit ranking with fairness monitoring
Check-in	Rotating venue QR + staff fallback; mission-window-only location	Risk-based signals and venue device management
Media	Direct uploads, resumable workflow, virus/type/count checks	Automated QC, rights metadata, lifecycle storage
Review / disputes	One defined revision and support escalation	SLA queues, evidence bundles, policy-based resolutions
Payments	Stripe Connect test mode; ledger + webhooks	Reconciliation, reserves, controlled live rollout, finance ops

Technology thesis

The existing plan proposes a native-feeling React Native/Expo iPhone app, a Next.js business/admin dashboard, a NestJS API, PostgreSQL, Azure Container Apps and Blob Storage, Service Bus, managed identity/Key Vault, Terraform, OpenTelemetry, and Stripe Connect. That stack is credible, but architecture is not the investment thesis. The minimum valuable product is the full test-mode workflow from funded mission through verified check-in, submission, approval, and reconciled payout—not a polished mission feed.

Trust and regulatory design

- FTC disclosures: payment, free meals, products, discounts, or experiences are material connections. Disclosures must be clear, conspicuous, and placed with the endorsement; the business must not require a positive review. [11]
- Content rights: record permitted channels, duration, territory, edits, paid-media usage, exclusivity, and raw-file ownership before application.

- Worker classification: define missions as outcome-based independent work only after state-specific employment counsel reviews control, scheduling, economic dependence, and classification risk.
- Payments: use processor-hosted onboarding, KYC, ledgering, reconciliation, reserves, refunds, and disputes. Do not expose identity, tax, or bank data to businesses.
- Privacy: collect precise location only when the check-in purpose is immediate; store the minimum evidence; expose only coarse locality to businesses; never sell raw location history.
- Safety: prohibit sensitive venues/categories, provide emergency/support paths, verify business locations, and carry insurance appropriate to the operating model.

DATA MOAT RULE Use performance data to improve fit and trust. Do not turn surveillance into the moat. A buyer will value clean consent, rights, and measurement data more than a privacy liability.

13 Five-year financial case and capital plan

The base case assumes a slow Orlando proof year, one replication year, and disciplined multi-city expansion. It is designed to expose the operating leverage required—not to promise the outcome.

Base case: density first, then measured city replication

Illustrative management case; \$ millions

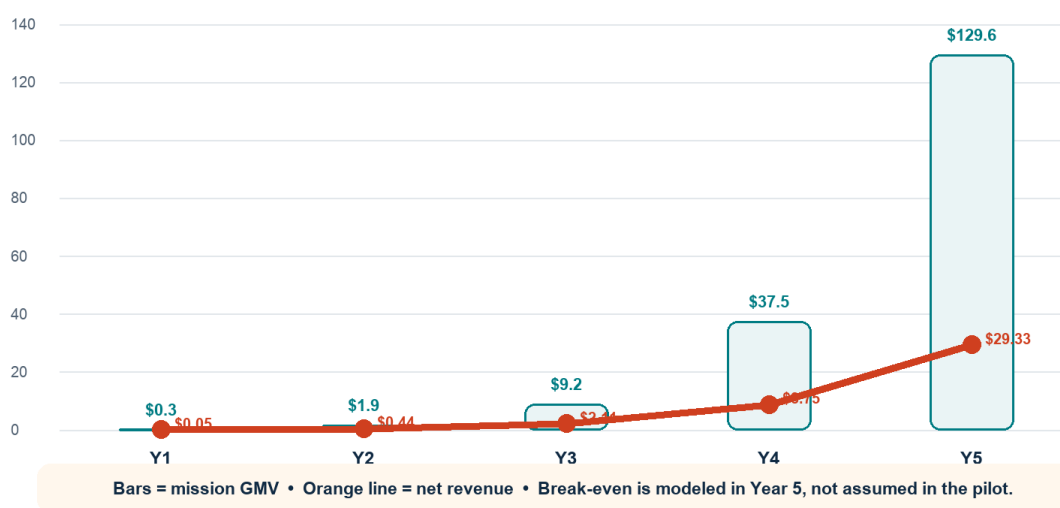


Figure 4. Illustrative base-case GMV and net revenue. The plan models break-even in Year 5 after four years of investment.

Base case	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5
Ending active businesses	75	300	1,000	3,000	8,000
Completed missions	300	1,800	8,000	30,000	96,000
Average mission GMV	\$1,000	\$1,050	\$1,150	\$1,250	\$1,350
Mission GMV	\$0.30M	\$1.89M	\$9.20M	\$37.50M	\$129.60M
Transaction net revenue (18%)	\$0.05M	\$0.34M	\$1.66M	\$6.75M	\$23.33M
SaaS / other revenue	\$0.00M	\$0.10M	\$0.45M	\$2.00M	\$6.00M
Total net revenue	\$0.05M	\$0.44M	\$2.11M	\$8.75M	\$29.33M
Gross margin	55%	60%	65%	70%	74%
Operating expense	\$1.20M	\$2.00M	\$3.80M	\$7.50M	\$15.50M
Illustrative EBITDA	(\$1.17M)	(\$1.74M)	(\$2.43M)	(\$1.38M)	\$6.20M

Capital strategy

Round	Milestone basis	Illustrative use
Pre-seed: \$1.0M–\$1.5M	Ship the end-to-end test-mode workflow; complete 200+ funded pilot missions; prove ≥55% mission contribution margin	Product/engineering, trust & safety, pilot operations, counsel/insurance, Orlando partnerships
Seed: \$3M–\$5M	40%+ 90-day business repeat, 80%+ fill within 72h, <12-month CAC payback, repeatable Orlando acquisition	Automate operations, deepen Orlando, open 2–4 validated cities, agency/multi-location product
Series A or profitable path	\$5M+ ARR, 65%+ gross margin, city playbook works in multiple markets	Scale distribution, payments economics, enterprise integrations, measurement, selective M&A

The modeled losses imply roughly \$6.7 million of cumulative negative EBITDA before Year 5, excluding working-capital timing, capitalized development, taxes, financing costs, and downside cushion. A staged pre-seed plus seed plan is therefore more credible than a single undercapitalized round. If the pilot misses liquidity or margin gates, the company should narrow the wedge or stop before raising expansion capital.

Scenario sensitivity

Scenario	Year-5 condition	Implication
Bear	3,000 active businesses, six missions/year, support-heavy gross margin below 55%	Likely \$6M–\$10M revenue ceiling; reposition as vertical SaaS/managed service or stop geographic expansion.

Scenario	Year-5 condition	Implication
Base	8,000 active businesses, 12 missions/year, 74% gross margin, \$29.3M revenue	Credible strategic acquisition or continued growth case; Year-5 operating profitability.
Upside	12,000 active businesses, 15 missions/year, agency/multi-location mix, >75% gross margin	Potential \$50M+ revenue platform with national strategic value; requires exceptional repeat and automation.

14 Risks and kill criteria

A serious plan says what can kill the company and how quickly management will know.

Risk	Early warning	Mitigation / kill criterion
Chicken-and-egg liquidity	Fill <60% or >7 days after 100 missions	Narrow geography/vertical; if two focused cells still fail, stop marketplace expansion.
Low business repeat	90-day repeat <25%	Interview cohorts, tighten ICP, improve measurable offers; kill broad SMB thesis if repeat remains weak.
Agency economics	>60 support minutes per mission; gross margin <40%	Standardize, automate, price service tiers; reject custom work that cannot become product.
Creator quality / no-shows	Completion <80%; disputes >5%	Reliability tiers, deposits only if fair/legal, waitlists, business proof, support; pause risky categories.
Fraud / payment losses	Chargebacks and losses exceed reserve	Risk scoring, delayed availability, limits, reconciliation, processor controls, insurance.
Platform dependency	Social API or policy changes break reporting	Make base value the verified visit and licensed files; treat external posting analytics as an add-on.
Legal classification / licensing	Counsel finds worker or money-transmission exposure incompatible with model	Change control/payment architecture before live launch; never solve legal risk with marketing language.
Privacy / safety incident	Unauthorized data access or unsafe mission	Data minimization, access controls, incident response, prohibited categories, venue verification, insurance.
AI commoditizes content	Businesses value synthetic assets over local creators	Emphasize real visits, local proof, human distribution, rights, and measurable commerce—not generic content volume.

BOARD DISCIPLINE The company should maintain a written kill-criteria dashboard. Missing one quarter is a problem to diagnose; missing the same structural gate across two focused iterations is evidence, not bad luck.

15 Exit strategies

Build a company that can remain independent; preserve multiple strategic exits by owning local liquidity, workflow, and clean attribution data.

The most credible exits

Path	Likely buyer logic	Milestones that create leverage
Creator / social marketing platform	Adds offline/local activation, SMB access, verified visits, and creator payment workflow	\$15M+ net revenue, 20+ dense markets, strong business repeat, measurable lift, clean rights data
SMB operating system / CRM / marketing platform	Adds a transaction-driven local growth channel to an existing merchant base	Thousands of retained businesses, multi-location adoption, CRM/booking integrations, <12-month CAC payback
Payments / commerce platform	Adds mission GMV, connected accounts, local attribution, and merchant growth services	\$250M+ annual GMV, low losses, mature reconciliation, clear legal structure
Agency / holding company	Adds proprietary creator supply, local execution, and performance data	High campaign quality, agency channel revenue, city coverage, data/identity interoperability
Private-equity recap / profitable independence	Durable cash flow, recurring software mix, efficient city expansion	\$20M+ ARR, 15%–25% EBITDA, low concentration, documented operational playbook
IPO (not the base case)	Category-leading local activation infrastructure	\$100M+ net revenue, strong growth, multiple countries/verticals, durable margins and governance

Market signals from recent transactions

- Sprout Social acquired influencer-marketing and social-intelligence platform Tagger Media for \$140 million in 2023, explicitly to expand workflow, reporting, and intelligence. [14]
- Later acquired everyday-influencer/social-commerce platform Mavely in a transaction valued at approximately \$250 million in January 2025, emphasizing full-funnel creator marketing and measurable ROI. [15]
- Publicis Groupe acquired Influential in 2024 to combine creator activation with identity, data, media planning, and measurement. The disclosed strategic logic—not an implied Local Missions valuation—is the relevant signal. [16]
- Intuit's approximately \$12 billion Mailchimp acquisition illustrates the long-run strategic value of combining SMB operating data with customer acquisition and marketing workflows. It is a strategic adjacency, not a direct comparable. [17]

EXIT PRINCIPLE Do not optimize the company for a logo list of potential acquirers. Optimize for strategic scarcity: dense local supply, retained merchant demand, trusted transaction history, measurable commerce, and a clean legal/data posture.

16 Milestones and investor conclusion

The investment case should be re-underwritten at each evidence gate.

Window	Build / sell	Proof required
0–3 months	Finalize M0 legal/product decisions; clickable prototype; 20 business discovery partners; recruit founding creator cohort	Signed pilot criteria, pricing interviews, prohibited-category policy, mission templates, data model
4–9 months	End-to-end dev/test workflow; 50 white-glove missions	Funding-to-payout audit trail, ≥75% fill, ≥85% completion, processor reconciliation, support-cost baseline
10–15 months	200+ cumulative paid missions; standard pricing; Local Pass attribution	≥80% fill, ≥90% completion, ≥40% business repeat, ≥45% creator repeat, ≥55% contribution margin
16–24 months	300 active Orlando businesses; agency/multi-location beta; second-city readiness	<12-month CAC payback, repeatable acquisition, 8-week expansion gate, no founder heroics
24–36 months	2–4 cities; 1,000 active businesses; automation and subscription product	\$2M+ annualized net revenue, 65%+ gross margin, low concentration, stable trust metrics

The investor case in one paragraph

Local Missions can become the operating layer that lets a neighborhood business buy authentic local participation as easily as it buys digital ads—while giving everyday adults legitimate paid creator work and giving both sides transparent rules, evidence, and payment states. The market is large enough, the Orlando wedge is unusually strong, and current platform economics support the model. But the company is only venture-scale if repeat demand, local density, and automation compound together. The right investment is a staged bet on proof: build the complete transaction, price it honestly, measure every failure, and expand only when one city cell works.

RECOMMENDATION Proceed to a tightly scoped Orlando pilot and pre-seed raise only after founder/team credibility, legal/payment architecture, and 20 paying design-partner commitments are documented. Make the first board dashboard the liquidity-and-unit-economics scorecard—not downloads or registered users.

A Appendix: assumptions, research, and source notes

All external figures are cited. All company forecasts and market layers are management assumptions unless explicitly attributed.

Key management assumptions

Assumption	Base case	Validation method
Platform fee	18% of creator reward GMV	Price 20 design partners; test 15% / 18% / 20% conversion and repeat
Average mission GMV	\$1,000 in Y1 rising to \$1,350 in Y5	Observe funded cohorts by vertical and creator count
Mission frequency	4 per business in Y1; 12 in Y5	Measure cohort repeat, seasonality, and subscription adoption
Payment pass-through	~\$60 per \$1,000 mission	Reconcile actual processor, Connect, payout, refund, and dispute costs
Contribution margin	55% pilot; 74% blended Y5 gross margin	Time-track support; allocate fraud, cloud/media, insurance, and verification per mission
Business CAC	\$450 pilot; \$300 density target	Fully loaded channel cohort including sales time and partner fees
Annual business retention	60% pilot model; 70% density target	Logo and GMV retention by acquisition cohort
U.S. mission-suitable venues	1.2 million	Replace with NAICS-by-metro establishment data and documented eligibility filter

Source notes

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Internal project basis

This business plan also incorporates the Local Missions build contract at plans.md and the synthetic concept walkthrough at ux-walkthrough/README.md in the Creator App repository. Those files define the intended workflow and product boundaries; they are not evidence of implemented production software or live market traction.